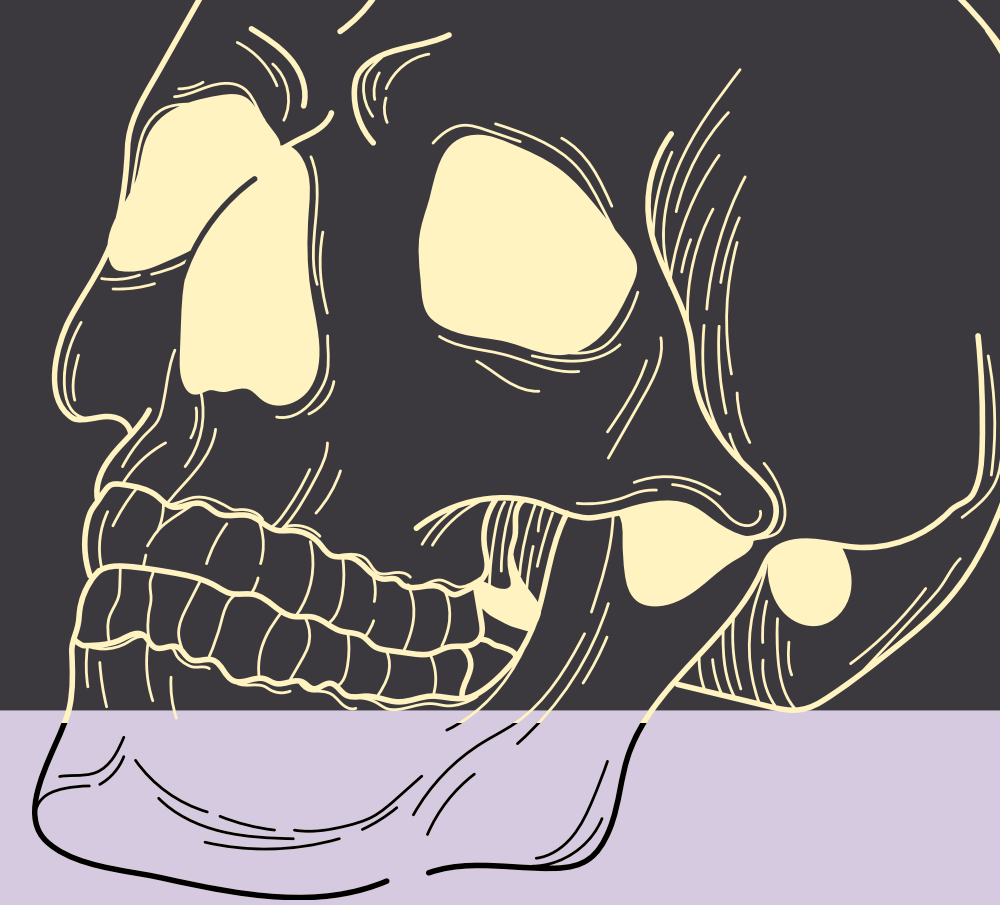
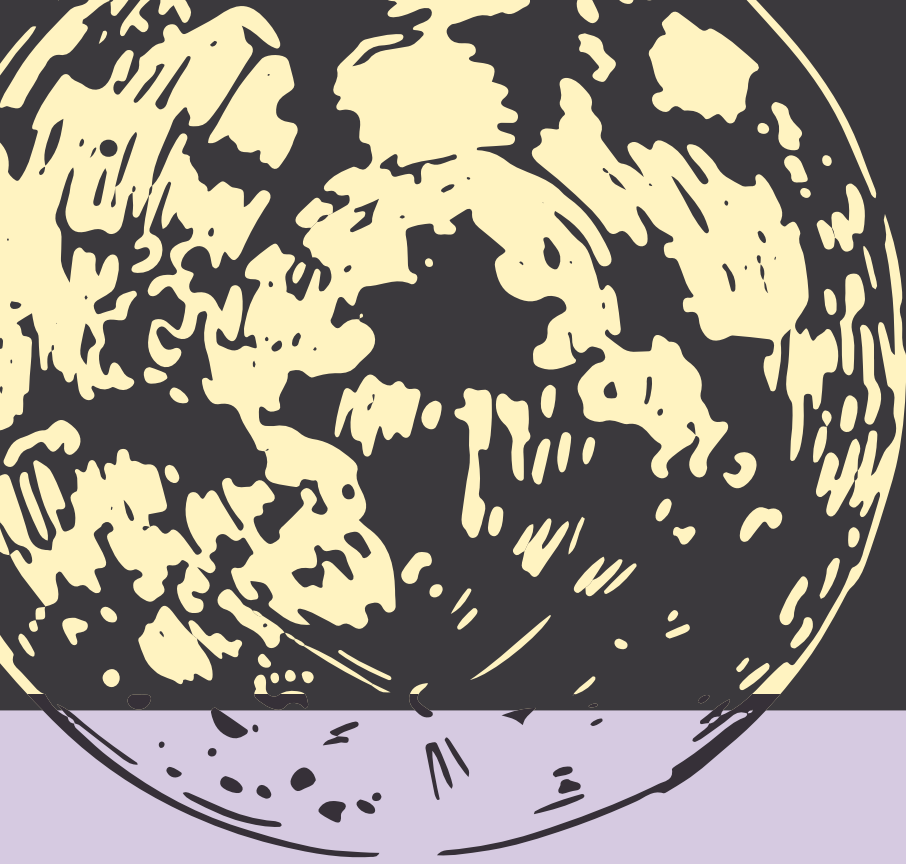




Markus's Miasma: Market Analysis

CMPM 172



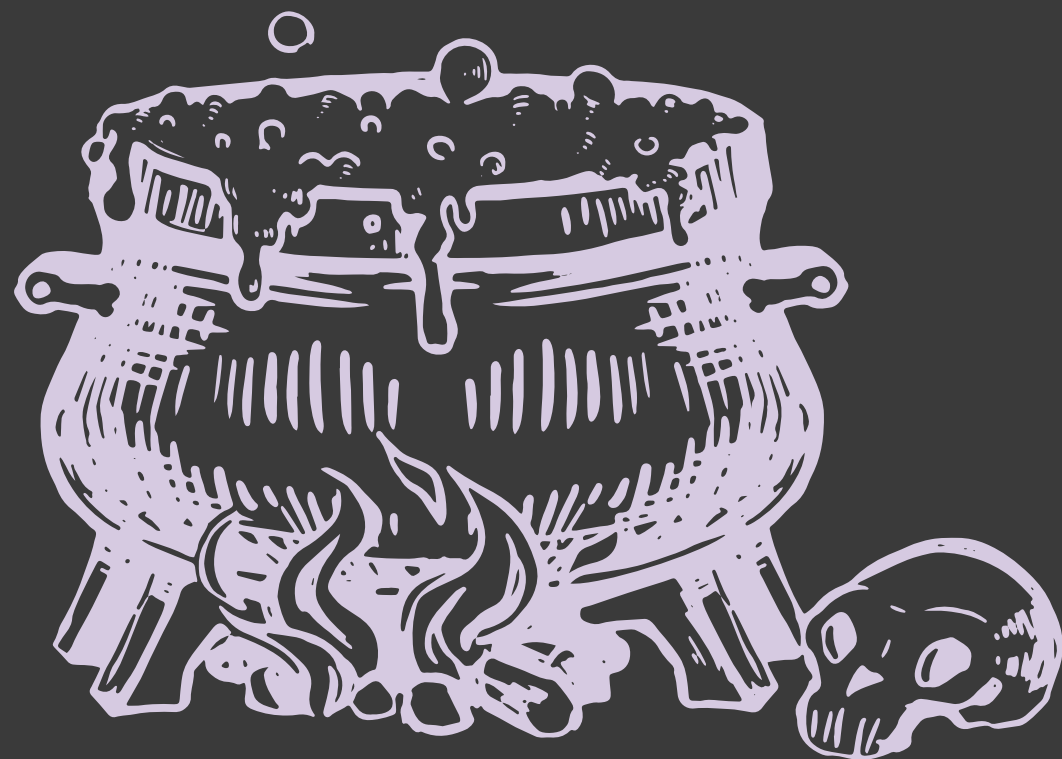
Elevator Pitch:

A 2D puzzle horror game set in a warped, fog-drenched version of UCSC, where the mist conceals unsettling truths and long-buried memories. Players navigate eerie campus landmarks, solving cryptic puzzles to uncover the dark story behind Markus's obsession. Inspired by narrative-heavy horror titles like *Mad Father* and the atmospheric dread of *Silent Hill*, this game blends emotional storytelling with psychological mystery.



The Big Picture

TAM



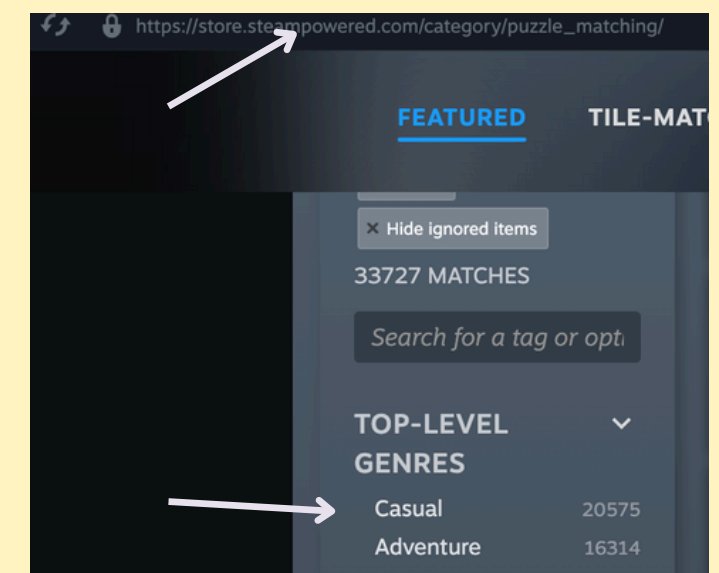
TAM

Total Addressable Market

Market: Narrative puzzle games, psychological storytelling, and indie games. *Popular titles are Viewfinder, Mad Father, Little Misfortune, and Detention.*

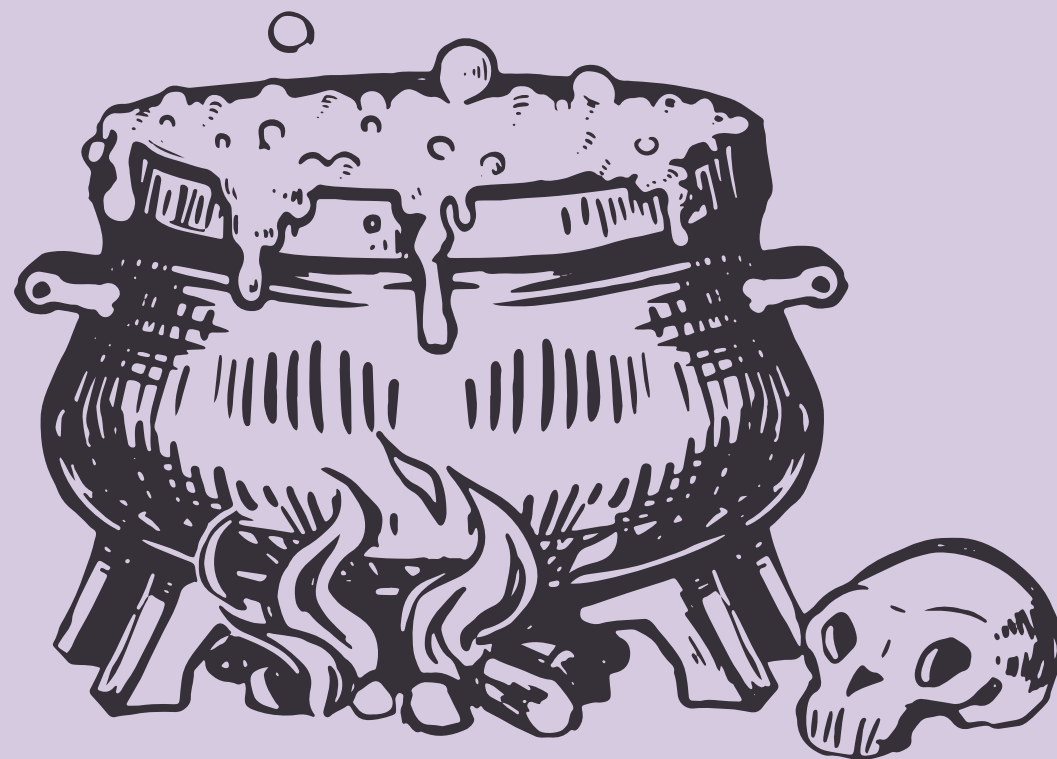
Estimate: Steam has over 16,000 puzzle/adventure games with a *guess* of combined revenue in the \$1B+ range annually. Indie narrative puzzle games like *Viewfinder* had a popular demand for their experimental game mechanics.

Markus's Miasma: Our game targets this entire genre. People who enjoy puzzle heavy and atmospheric games will be drawn to our game.



The Big Picture

SAM



SAM

Serviceable Addressable Market

Player Market: Players on PC/Steam who enjoy creepy/light horror elements and puzzle-solving in games. Along with those who enjoy a more low-res aesthetic.

Estimate: ~500K - 1M players engage with puzzle games. As reviews are only ~5% of players that played the game.

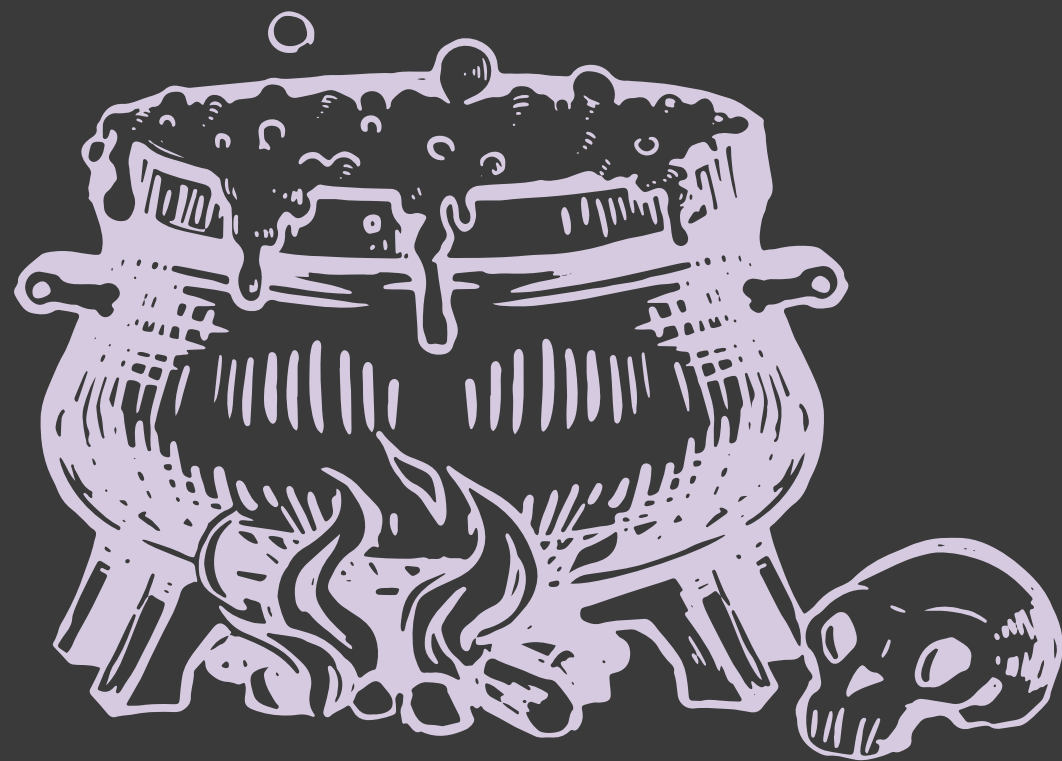
Similar Games: *Mad Father* has ~5,000 reviews (~5% of players leave reviews)

Markus's Miasma: Falling into this genre, as our game focuses on the creepy puzzle elements.



The Big Picture

SOM



SOM

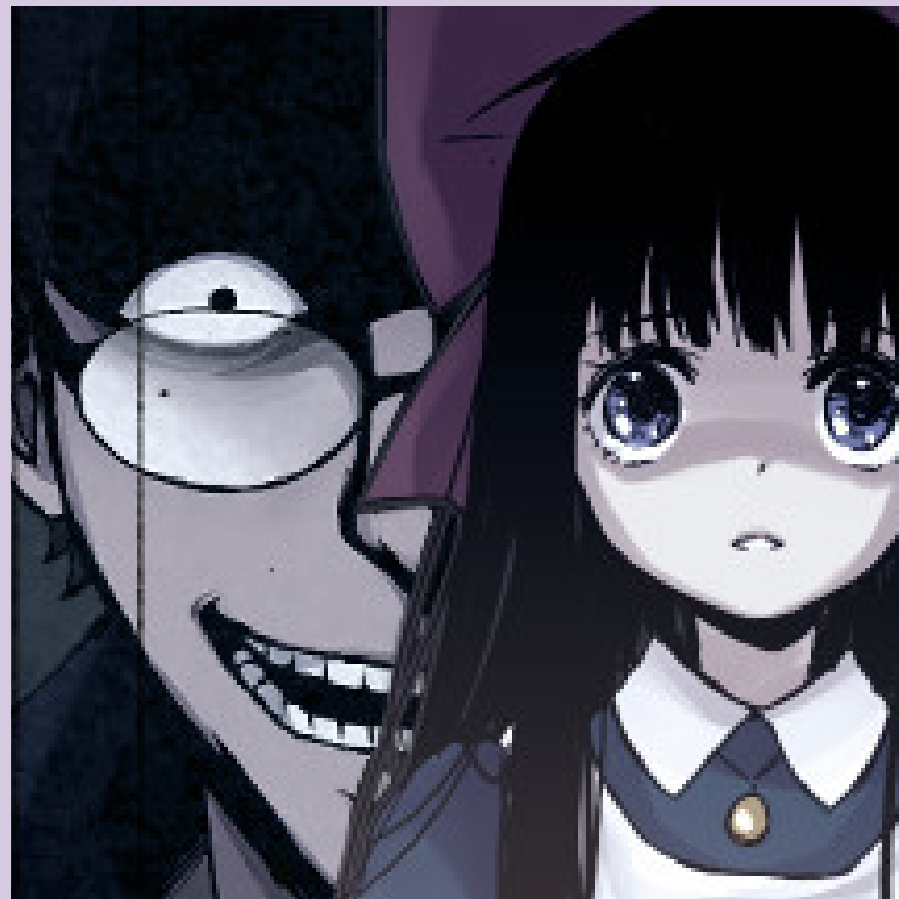
Serviceable Obtainable Market

Realistic Market: UCSC community and Santa Cruz indie players. We can also create traction from BlueSky and TikTok.

Player Estimate: ~350 potential players during the early stages of our release. There are at least 100 students in our capstone course.

Markus's Miasma: Our biggest selling point is the landmarks of UCSC, which can resonate with alumni and students. Which will be our early traction.

Deep Dive: Mad Father



Genre: 2D Puzzle Horror Adventure

Art Style: RPG Maker

Platform: Steam, Nintendo Switch

Price: \$9.99

Steam Reviews: 5,000+ with Overwhelming Positive Reviews

Themes: Obsession, Family Secrets, Psychological Horror

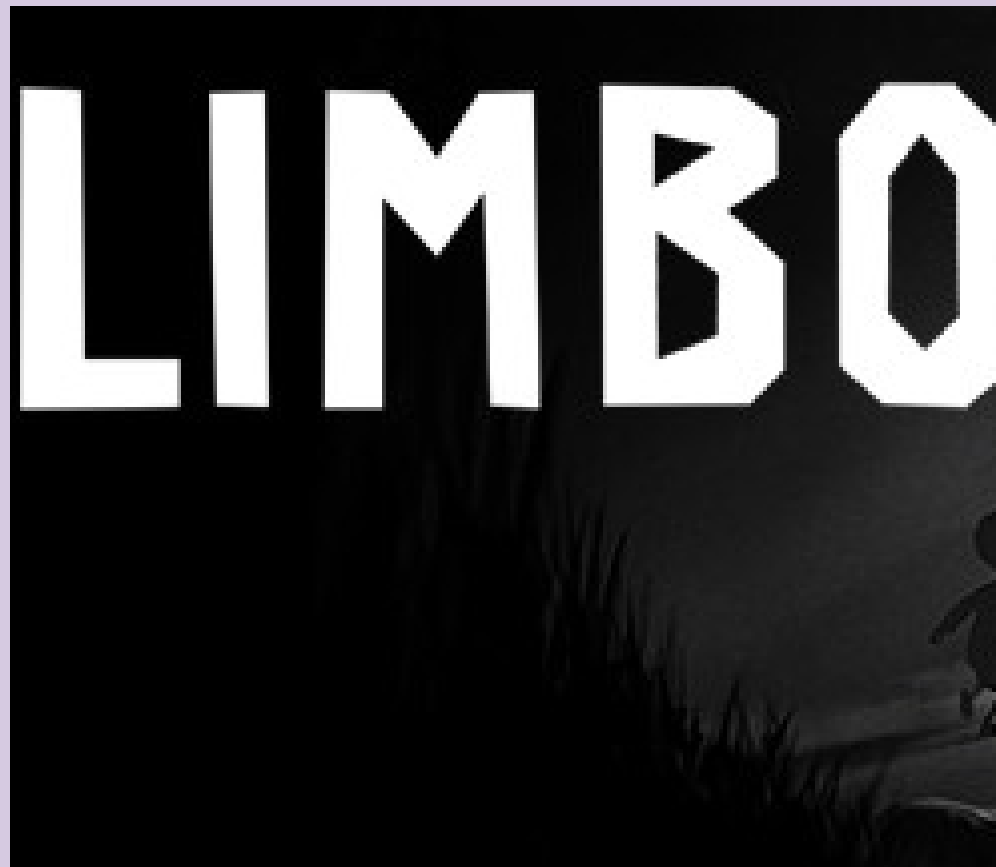
Why It Succeeded: Multiple endings, emotional narrative around a child, strong community support with Let's Plays.

Why It Struggled: Predictable plot points

Marketing on Steam: "Help Aya uncover the mystery of her father's dark experiments in this remake of a cult classic horror game."

Marketing via community: Promoted through horror content creators.

Deep Dive: Limbo



Genre: 2D Puzzle Platformer

Art Style: Minimalist

Platform: Everything under the sun

Price: \$9.99

Steam Reviews: 35,000+ with a “Very Positive” rating

Themes: Death, Failure, Separation

Why It Succeeded: Engaging art style, linear, appealing price point, extremely positive buzz from news outlets

Why It Struggled: Unclear puzzles, narrative, and pacing

Marketing on Steam: "Uncertain of his sister's fate, a boy enters LIMBO."

Marketing via community and positive word-of-mouth: Promoted through horror content creators and received critical praise (IGN's Game of 2010, etc.)

The UCSC-er

"I've walked here!"

Who: Current UCSC students/alumni/Santa Cruz Locals

How they Play: Taking it slower as they talk about the landmarks with friends.

Motivation: Nostalgia, with a creepy twist.

Unique Trait: Tied to the settings and having memories with the campus.

The Puzzle Pro

"Don't tell me the solution"

Who: Indie players, strategist

How they Play: Power through the puzzles efficiently, and may take notes.

Motivation: Challenge, completionist

Unique Trait: Less focus on narrative and enjoys messing with the mechanics.

The Lorekeeper

"What happened to Markus?"

Who: Lore hunters, writers

How they Play: Reads every note and thoughtful.

Motivation: Hidden truths, story depth.

Unique Trait: They dig into the meaning and symbolism that the story shows.

The Unafraid

"I'm here for the spooky vibes"

Who: Horror buffs

How they Play: Fast pace and fearless.

Motivation: Unsettling themes, adrenaline

Unique Trait: They embrace the tension and are looking for unusual scares.

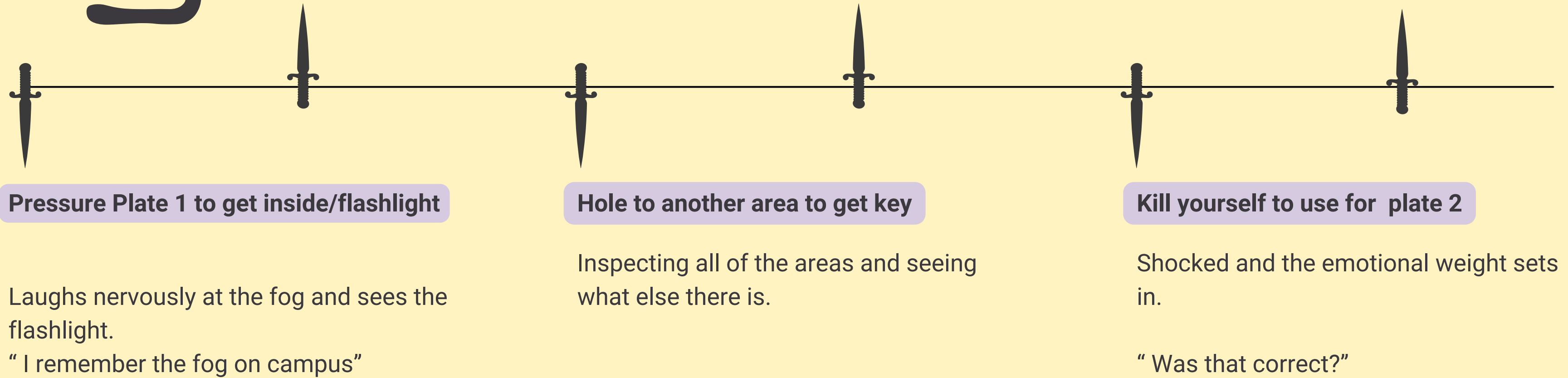
Player Profiles



5 Minutes of Gameplay: Tutorial Area

- 1 Pressure Plate 1 to get inside/flashlight
- 2 Drag Body to pressure plate 1
- 3 Hole to another area to get key
- 4 Unlock area with pressure plate 2
- 5 Kill yourself to use for plate 2
- 6 Unlock following areas

UCSC-er



Puzzle Pro



Pressure Plate 1 to get inside/flashlight

Immediately registers the pressure plate as a trigger to the next part.

“I know this one!”



Drag Body to pressure plate 1

Testing all of the interactions with the body.



Hole to another area to get key

Enters the tunnel and gets the key as fast as they can.



Unlock area with pressure plate 2

Connecting the corpse mechanic to this next step.



Kill yourself to use for plate 2

Does it quick and without the morbid thoughts.



Unlock following areas

Solves everything quickly and is excited for the next puzzles ahead.

Lorekeeper



Pressure Plate 1 to get inside/flashlight

Wonders what the flashlight represents symbolically.

“Is the fog a metaphor for trauma?”



Drag Body to pressure plate 1

Examines the body.

“Who is this?”



Hole to another area to get key

Theorizing what the holes represent.



Unlock area with pressure plate 2

Analyzing what their options are.



Kill yourself to use for plate 2

Sees how this mechanic is a turning point in the grander scheme of the plot.



Unlock following areas

Wanting to replay the puzzle before proceeding to think about what they were just shown.

Unafraid



Pressure Plate 1 to get inside/flashlight

Engages with the fog and flashlight instantly.



Drag Body to pressure plate 1

No hesitation in dragging the corpse.

“ Oh, so it’s that kind of morbid”



Hole to another area to get key

Jumps into the hole expecting a monster.



Unlock area with pressure plate 2

Remembering the corpse and not finding one nearby.



Kill yourself to use for plate 2

Laughs at the twist and finds it thrilling.



Unlock following areas

Feels rewarded by the death mechanic.



Quality of Life Features



Looking into QOF Features in Creepy Puzzle/Narrative Games that we will borrow!

Skippable Dialogue

Reduce frustration on replays.

Found in: Little Misfortune

Auto Save

Let players retry puzzles without punishment.

Found in: Fear and Hunger

Hint System

Prevents softlocks!

Found in: Viviette

Sound Cues

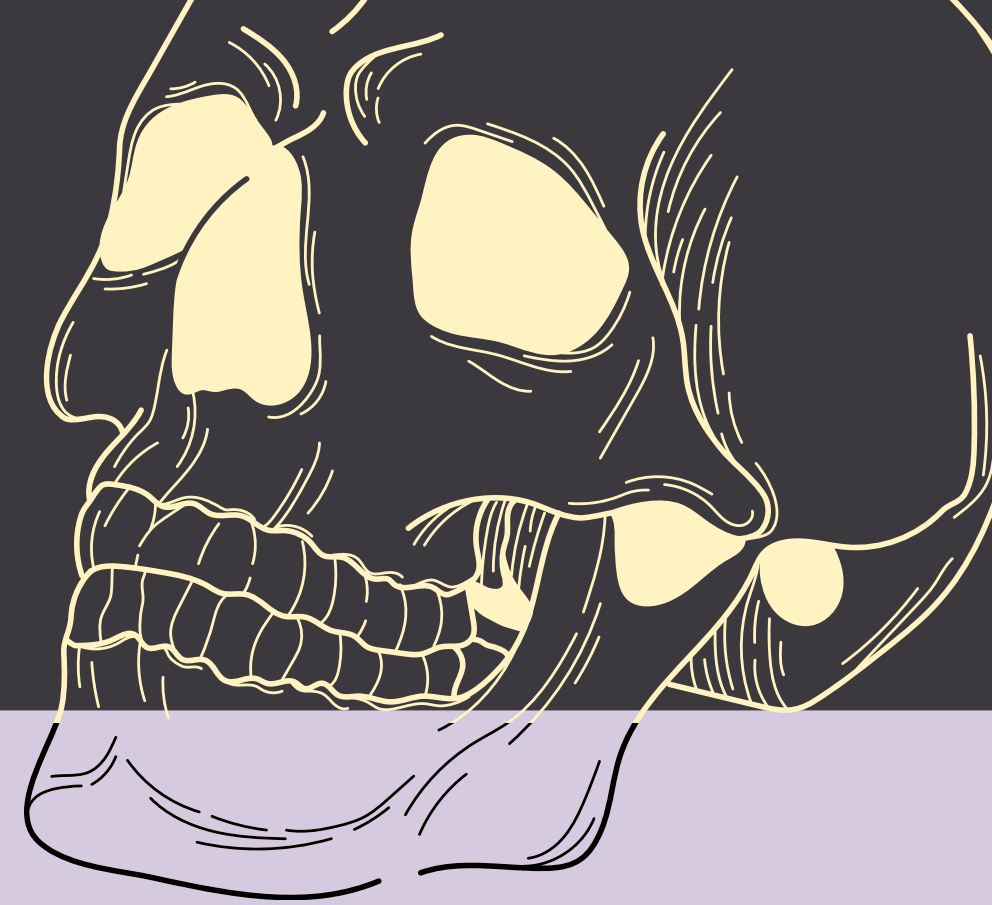
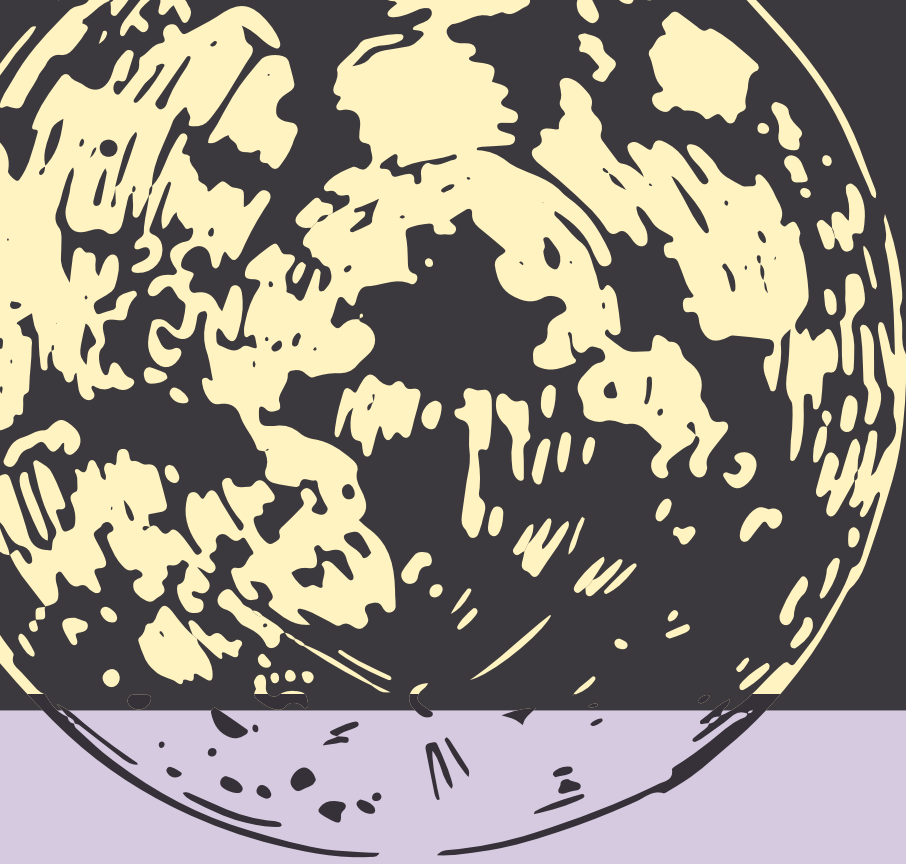
Helps navigate in FOW.

Found in: Inside

Rebindable Keys

Player control accessibility.

Found in: Most modern games on Steam



The End

Theme By: Canva

